

Television

The marvelous machine that brings the WORLD to your living room

From fuzzy pictures to high-definition images, watching television has kept us informed and entertained for decades.

By the way...

Some of my early inventions weren't successful: I cut myself badly with my rust-proof razor, and my air-soled shoes burst.

Baird achieved the first transatlantic TV transmission in 1928.

Baird's biscuit-tin TV

In 1926, an **excited audience** in London, England, became the first people ever to watch television. Scottish inventor **JOHN LOGIE BAIRD** had cobbled together a tea chest, biscuit tins, hat boxes, and darning needles to come up with a mechanical TV. The audience watched a scary-looking ventriloquist's dummy named **Stookie Bill**.

It paved the way for...



With the invention of **VIDEO CASSETTES** and **DVDs**, people could watch movies at home on TV.



Everyone could be a star after the **CAMCORDER** was invented in 1980.

Switching on

Although they were exciting, Baird's television pictures were so **FUZZY** that his system was soon abandoned.

A few years later, Russian-American inventor Vladimir Zworykin improved the **cathode-ray tube** (a device for showing images on a screen), and used it in a new type of electrical TV.

Sales had skyrocketed by the 1950s, with millions of people enjoying news and entertainment via the magic of moving pictures **in their homes**.